

From data sprawl to data confidence

Preparing your Microsoft 365 workspaces for data governance

About me

Andries den Haan:

- Working in IT since '98
- Currently as a Solution consultant at Wortell
- Experience in healthcare, finance and public sector
- Started with SharePoint Portal Server 2001
- Content management, data governance and data migrations
- Occasional speaker
- Blog: www.tribework.nl.





BLUE

What we are going to talk about

- TL;DR
- The urgency
- Identify and prioritize
- Data Lifecycle & clean-up
- Reducing risk.

TL;DR

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An iceberg floating in a dark blue ocean. The tip of the iceberg, which is jagged and white, is visible above the water line. The much larger, submerged part of the iceberg is visible below the water line, illustrating the concept of hidden or lagging issues. The background is a dark, moody sky and sea.

**Although organizations
have been working with
Microsoft 365 for years,
data governance has been
structurally lagging!**

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Data governance is on the agenda (again)...

SharePoint
Server 2010



Office
365



Delve



Microsoft
Teams



Microsoft
365 Copilot



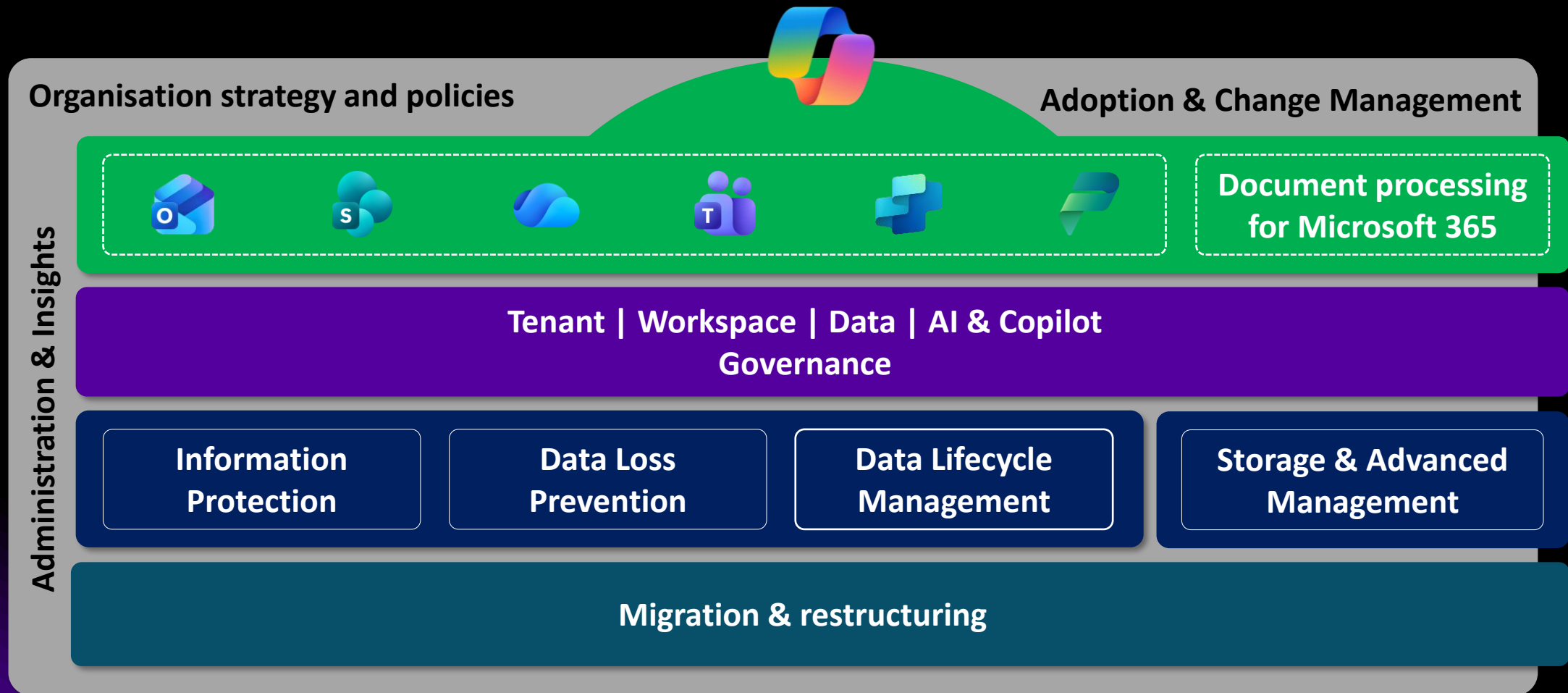
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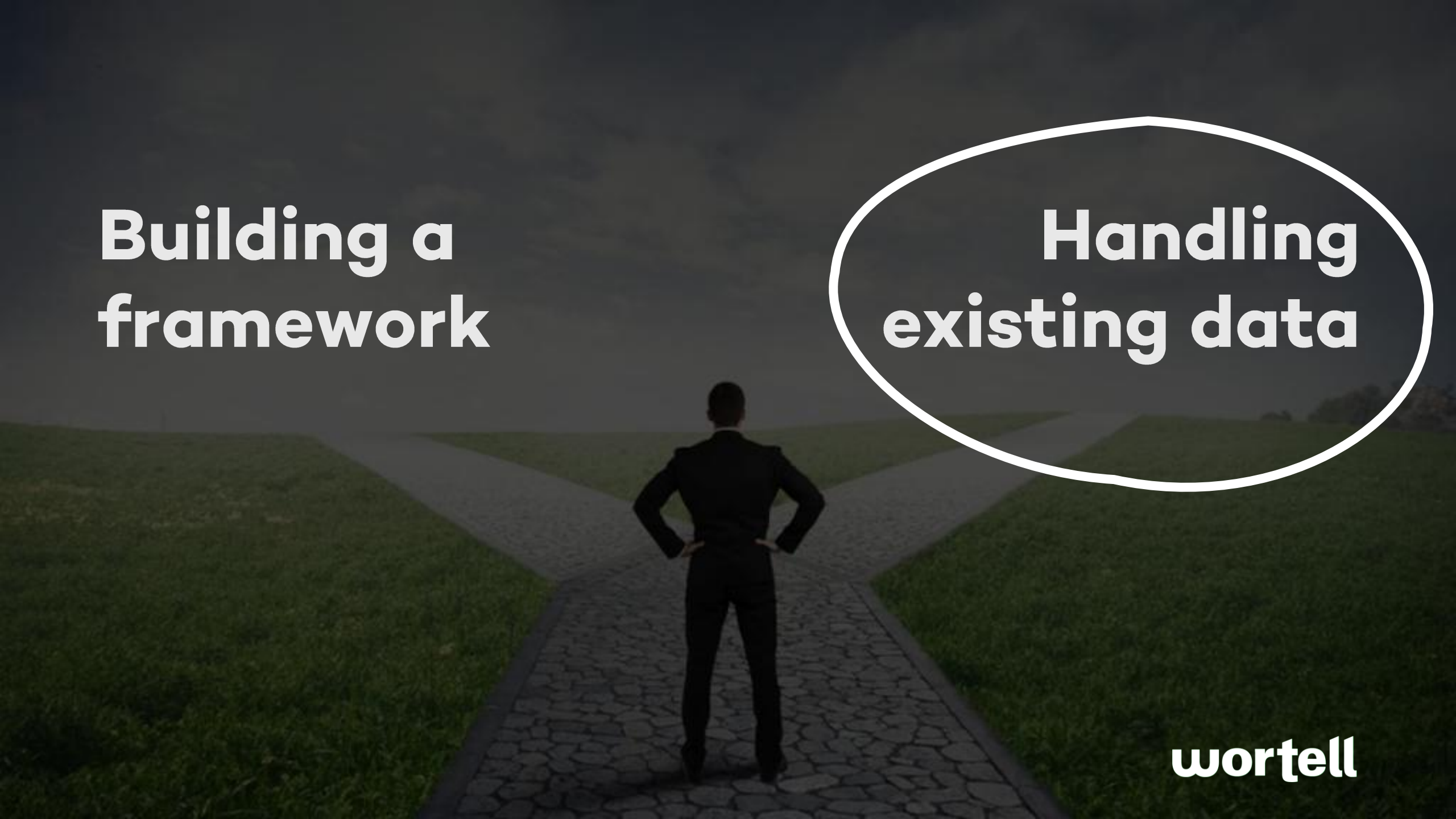


**Welcome in
the age of AI**

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Governing your data requires a holistic approach



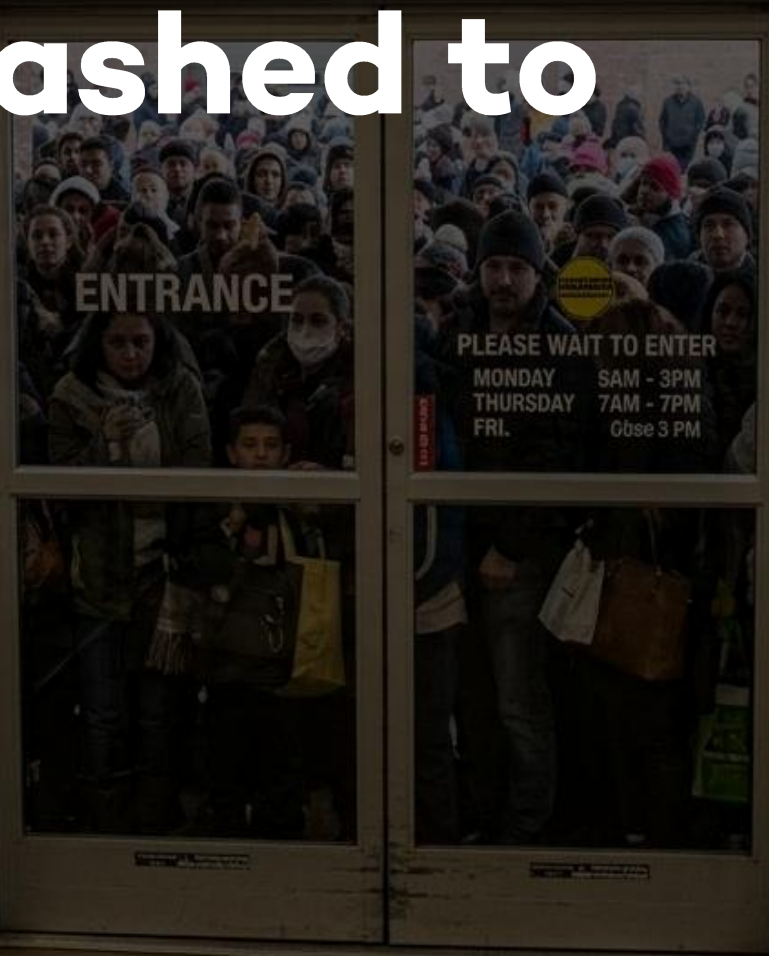


**Building a
framework**

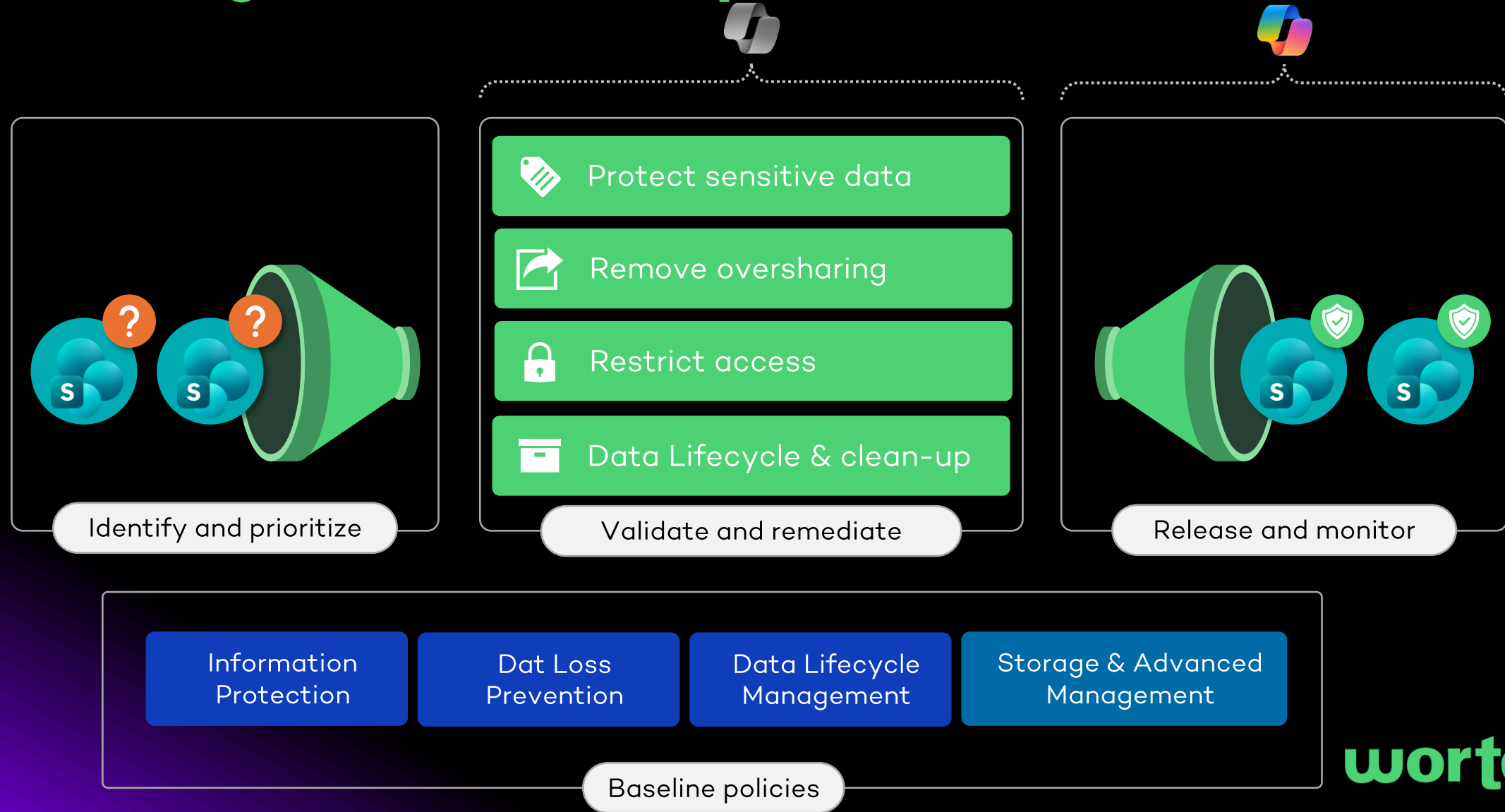
**Handling
existing data**

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Is your data ready to be unleashed to Copilot?



Getting from content sprawl to content confidence



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**Getting
your feet in
the mud!**

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Identify and prioritize sites and data

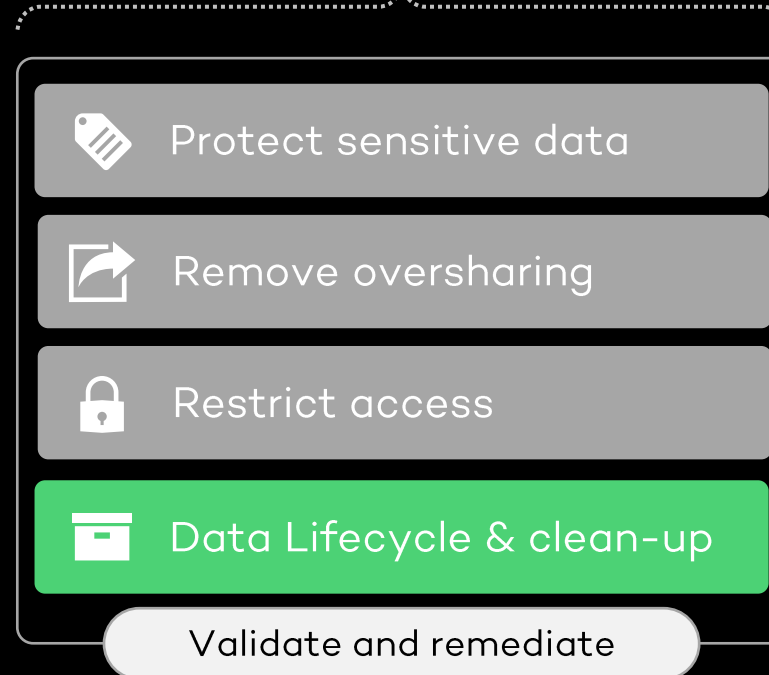
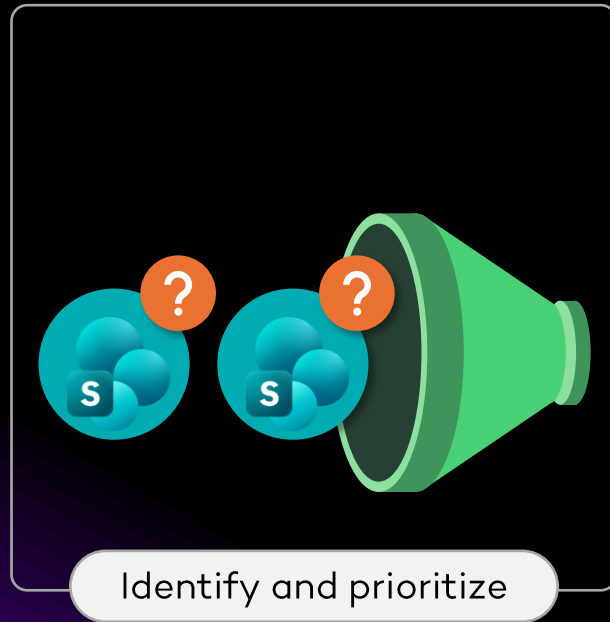
- A known list of sites containing sensitive data
- SAM Content Management Assessment
- DSPM Data Risk Assessments (E5)
- Script-based file-level inventory
- 3rd party tools.

...take a layered approach!

Restrict content discovery while validating and remediating

External file sharing ⓘ	Sensitivity label ⓘ
Only people in your organization ▼	Org Unit ▼
More sharing settings	
Restrict content from Microsoft 365 Copilot ⓘ PRO	Restricted site access ⓘ PRO
☒ On	Not set
☐ Off	Edit
Custom scripts ⓘ	Version history limit ⓘ
Blocked	Same as Organization-level (Manual)
Edit	

Data lifecycle & clean-up



Uncluttering active and stale data

- Microsoft Purview DLM:
 - Retention based on Last Accessed for files in OneDrive and SharePoint (Roadmap ID: 472030)
- Not only for compliance, but also for Copilot to work with current data
- SAM Site inactivity policies to auto-archive sites to Microsoft 365 Archive.

Script-based approach provides in-depth insights on usage patterns

- Can be used at scale, but scoping is recommended
- Valuable metrics:
 - Large sites, lists & files
 - Version usage patterns*
 - Dominant file types
 - Time-based (created, last modified)*

Setting version history limits

☒ **Automatically** RECOMMENDED
Automatically optimize storage using an intelligent algorithm to store versions based on creation date.
[Learn more about automatic limits](#)

☐ **Manually**
Versions are deleted when set number or time limits are exceeded.

Delete versions when this number is exceeded.

500

Time ⓘ

Delete versions after this period of time.

Never (Default) ▾

3 months

6 months

1 year

Never (Default)

Custom

- Version usage patterns determine effectiveness
- Automatic vs. manual
- Not for all sites.

Modified time range filter

From 0 Month To Indefinite

5

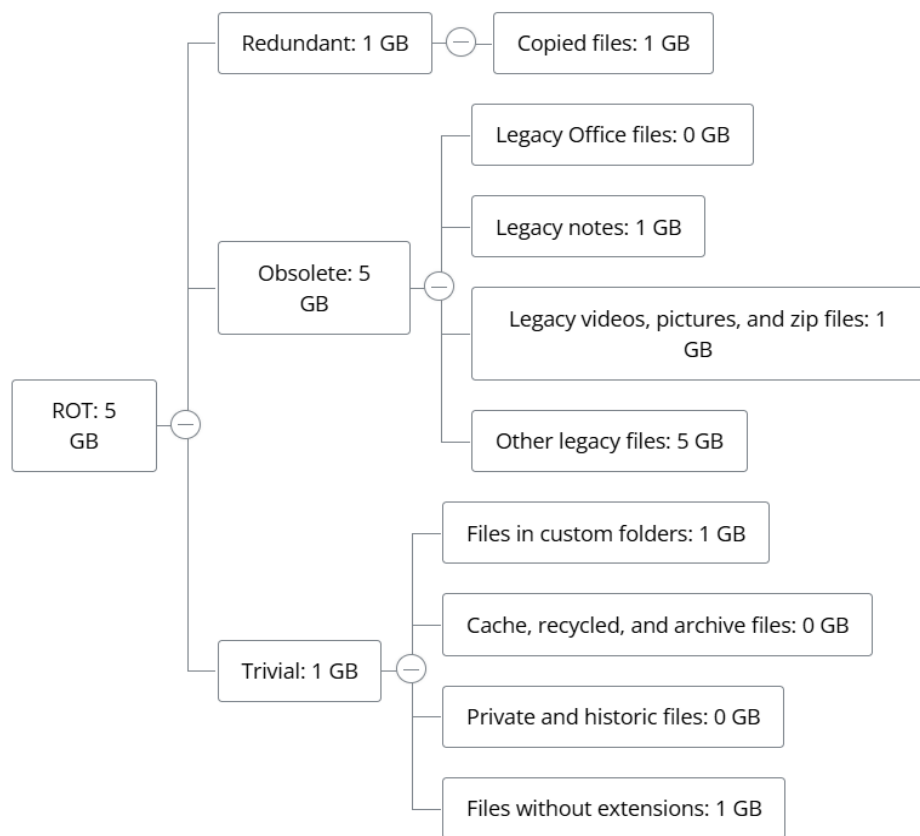
Data size (GB)

9,480

File count

ROT data takes up 100% of the data size of 5 GB.

Data size by ROT rule



Connections

Search by name

Connection group		R
☐	[REDACTED]	4
☐	[REDACTED]	2
Total		5

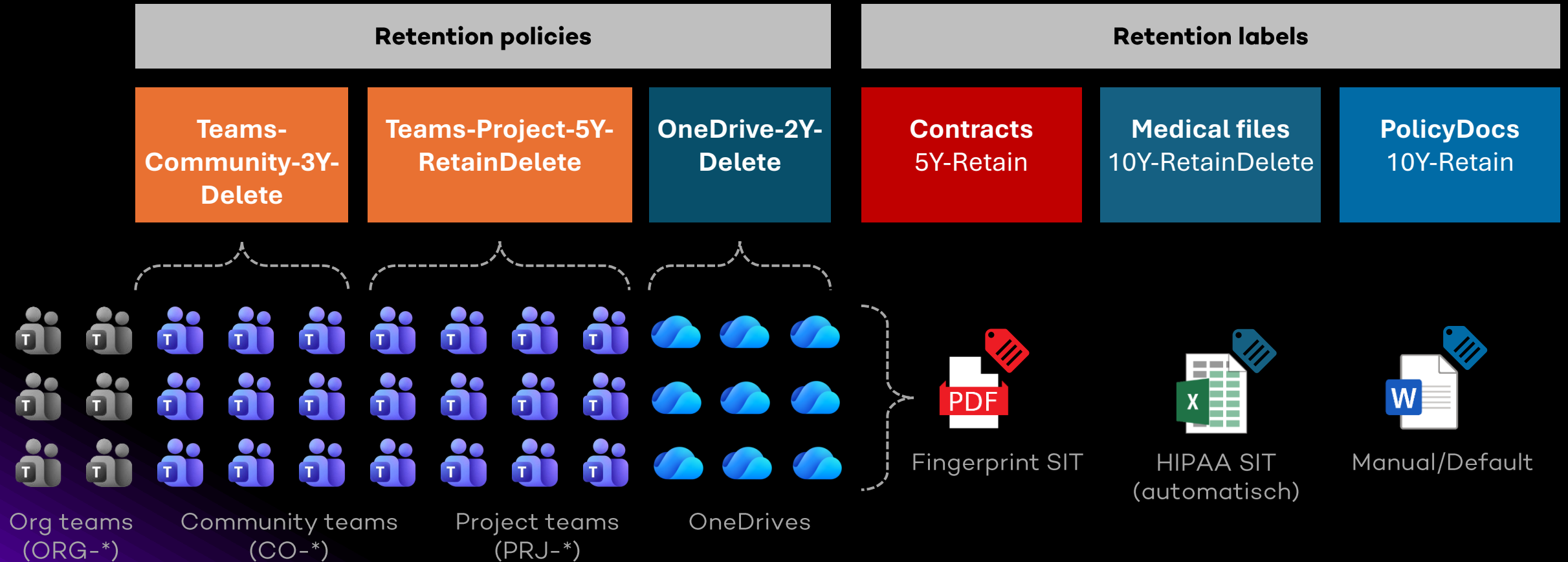
File size by type (GB)



- AvePoint Discovery & Analysis gathers information about the ROT in SharePoint and OneDrive
- Aggregates up to site-level
- Configurable detection rules.

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Implement a Data Lifecycle Management baseline with uniform building blocks



Use Dynamic scopes in Microsoft Purview to target DLM policies on similar containers

Adaptive scopes > Projects

Scope

Projects

↓ Export 7 items Refresh

Filters:  Filters

Display name	Location type	State
☐ https://contoso.sharepoint.com/sites/PRJ-HR-007	Site	Added
☐ https://contoso.sharepoint.com/sites/PRJ-Project-0023	Site	Added
☐ https://contoso.sharepoint.com/sites/PRJ-Project-0024	Site	Added

Details

Name
Projects

Description
Adaptive scope for projects where the site name starts with "PRJ-"

Admin unit
Full directory

Type
Site

Query summary
SiteTitle starts with PRJ-

The challenge with DLM...

- It can quickly become more complex than you think
- Not everything triggers on last modified data, also consider state changes (e.g., dossier closure or project completion*)
- More triggers are coming soon: Retention based on Last Accessed for files in OneDrive and SharePoint (Roadmap ID: 472030).

SAM Catalog Management to the rescue?

Catalog management

Select properties or values to edit the display name. Reports for each property and its associated values are generated daily.

[Learn about Catalog management](#)

☰ Group by custom properties

>	Property	Values	Sites	Site report
☒	▼ Locale	5	100,127	Download
		North America	42,215	Download
		South America	35,524	Download
		Europe	8,272	Download
		Asia	7,923	Download
		India	6,193	Download
>	Department	12	100,127	Download
>	User type	2	12,722	Download
>	Preferred data location (PDL)	4	100,127	Download
>	Information Barriers segment	6	28,876	Download

- Groups sites together based on e.g., geo, department or site properties
- Uses site and user metadata to determine the grouping
- SAM policies expected to use this in the future to target policies, e.g. projects that are “Completed”.

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Make Copilot only look at active data and reduce storage at the same time?

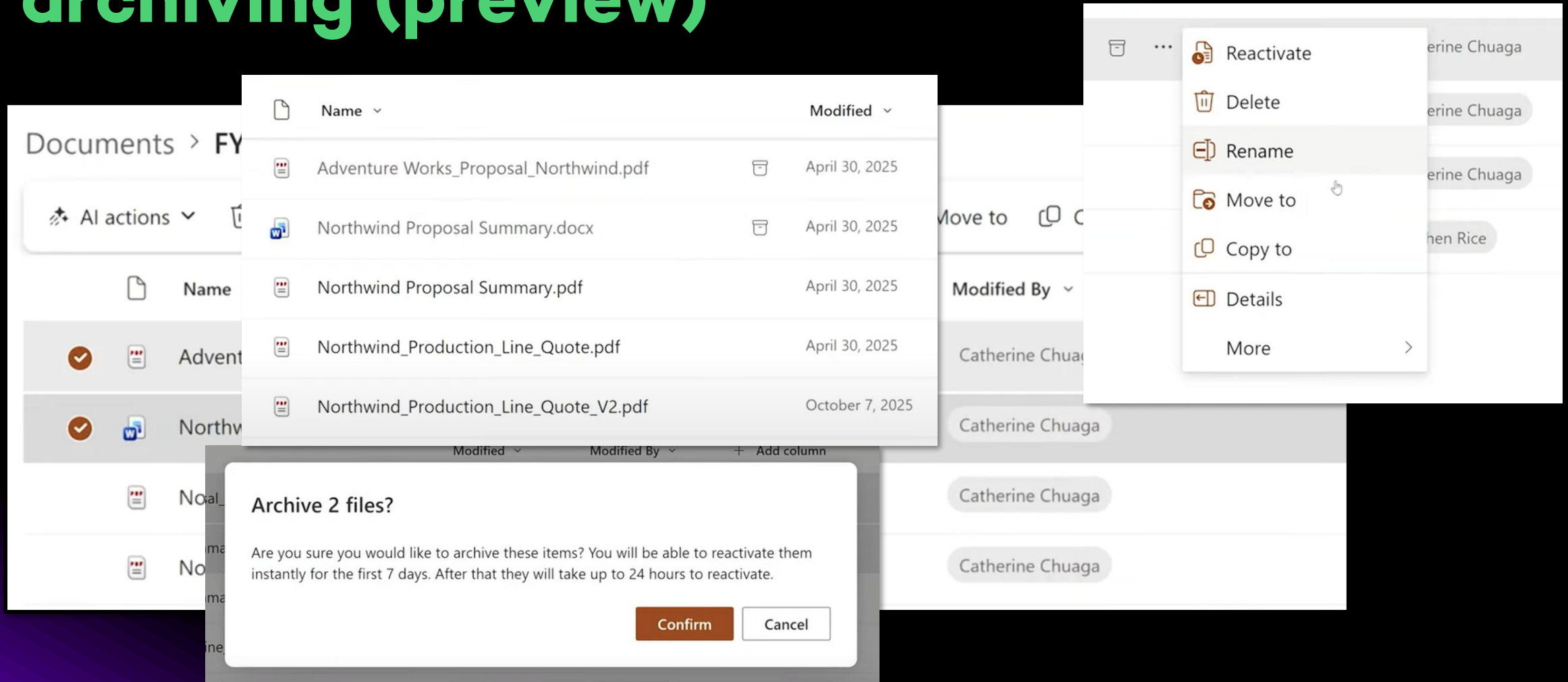
Microsoft 365 Archive file-level archiving is coming (Roadmap ID: 477371), but be aware of the fine-print:

"File-level archive doesn't change site storage usage or quota behavior. Archived files are accounted for in site storage the same way as active files. Archiving a file doesn't reduce reported storage usage, change storage calculations, or affect quota enforcement. Because archived files continue to consume site storage, file-level archive can't be used to reduce storage usage or store data beyond a site's allocated quota."

Site-level archiving does in fact reduce active storage consumption.

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/archive/archive-faq?view=o365-worldwide#how-does-file-level-archive-preview-impact-my-site-level-storage>

Microsoft 365 Archive file-level archiving (preview)



SAM Inactive site policies for automatic archiving

Set policy scope

How do you want to select the sites for the policy? *

- ☐ Upload a CSV file with a list of up to 10,000 URLs
- ☒ Select sites at scale

Which sites should be checked for inactivity? *

OneDrive sites are excluded automatically.

Teams-connected sites

☒ Filter by sensitivity label

Org Unit

☒ Filter by site creation source

Site provisioning solutionj

☒ Include sites with retention policies and retention holds

Select an enforcement type:

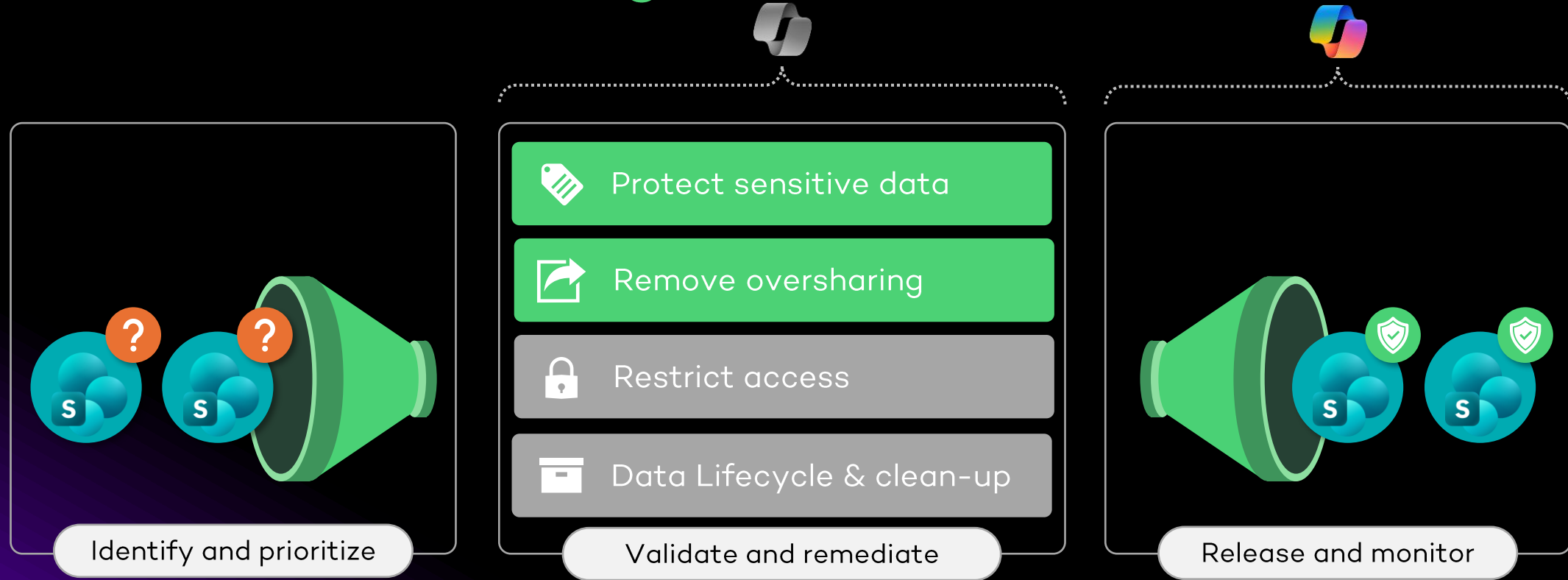
- ☐ Read-only access
- ☒ Archive sites after mandatory read-only period **RECOMMENDED**

Users cannot access archived sites.

Duration of read-only period *

9 maanden

Remove oversharing & Protect sensitive data



Data risk assessments

Assess and prevent oversharing

1 Identify

Review assessment results for users accessing sensitive items. You can review the weekly results from the default assessment or create custom assessments to review specific data sources and users.

2 Protect

Limit Microsoft Copilot and agents access to sensitive data and apply label and retention policies to SharePoint sites and data.

3 Monitor

Conduct SharePoint site and access reviews to evaluate permissions and user access.

Default assessment

Assess oversharing of sensitive data for the top 100 SharePoint sites based on how many times the sites are accessed. Results are derived from data collected over the last 30 days.

Results

Total items

684

Sensitive data detected

374

Sharing links accessed by Anonymous/External

0

Last updated

15 Dec 2025

Next update

22 Dec 2025

Frequency

Weekly

View details

Custom assessment status

6

In Progress

Completed

Review results to identify potential oversharing risks in your organization and apply fixes, such as limiting access to sensitive data and evaluating access to SharePoint sites.

Export

Scoped assessment

54 items

Group

Customize columns

☐	Data source ID	Source type	Total items	Total items accessed	Times users accessed items	Unique users accessing items	Total sensitive items
☐	/sites/prj-fabrikam/	SharePoint	175	0	0	0	125
☐	/sites/prj-herinrichtingbinnenstadext/	SharePoint	65	0	0	0	31
☐	/sites/collegedegrees/	SharePoint	29	0	0	0	27
☐	/sites/projects/	SharePoint	19	0	0	0	15
☐	/sites/prj-contosomerger/	SharePoint	16	0	0	0	10
☐							

Resolve oversharing and apply sensitivity labels

Human resources

Overview Potentially overshared items New

Potentially overshared items

2 items are potentially overshared in your scoped sources. An item is overshared if it is shared with multiple users and contains sensitive information or a sensitivity label. View items

Human resources

Overview Potentially overshared items

☰ ✓ Resolve ✉ Notify ⋮ More actions ✓ 1 item selected ⬇ Export selected item

☐	File name		Sensitivity labels	Owner
☐	⌵ 🌐 https://contoso.sharepoint	—	—	—
☒	> 📄 classified report.pdf (1) Anyone	⌵ ⚙️ Apply sensitivity label ⌵ 🗑️ Remove sharing link	—	
☐	> 📄 strategy change plan.ppt Anyone		—	

AvePoint Insights

Contributing factors

Last aggregated time 3/10/2026 12:12:39

Manage sensitivity label

Policy Recommendation Run policy

Search by name Filter Columns

Export for all Refresh 0 selected

	Name	Object type	Shared by	Shared with	Inherit from	Permission	Created	Site name	Expiration da...	Sensitivity le...
☐	Balance Scor...	File	Nestor Wilke	0	Unique	Edit	5/12/2021 11:...	Admin Portal	None	Medium
☐	Staff Trainnin...	File	Julian Vance	0	Unique	Edit	4/25/2021 13:...	Portal Manag...	None	High
☐	Scrum-Simula...	File	Julian Vance	0	Unique	Edit	4/25/2021 13:...	Portal Manag...	None	Medium
☐	Team Meetin...	File	Julian Vance	0	Unique	Edit	4/25/2021 13:...	Security Infor...	4/28/2022	High
☐	Travel Newsle...	File	Julian Vance	0	Unique	Edit	4/25/2021 13:...	Security Infor...	None	Medium
☐	2013 Stakeho...	File	Julian Vance	Megan Bowen	Unique	View	4/25/2021 11:...	JP Team	5/26/2021	High
☐	Veteran Statu...	File	Julian Vance	0	Unique	Edit	4/25/2021 11:...	JP Team	None	High

10 rows

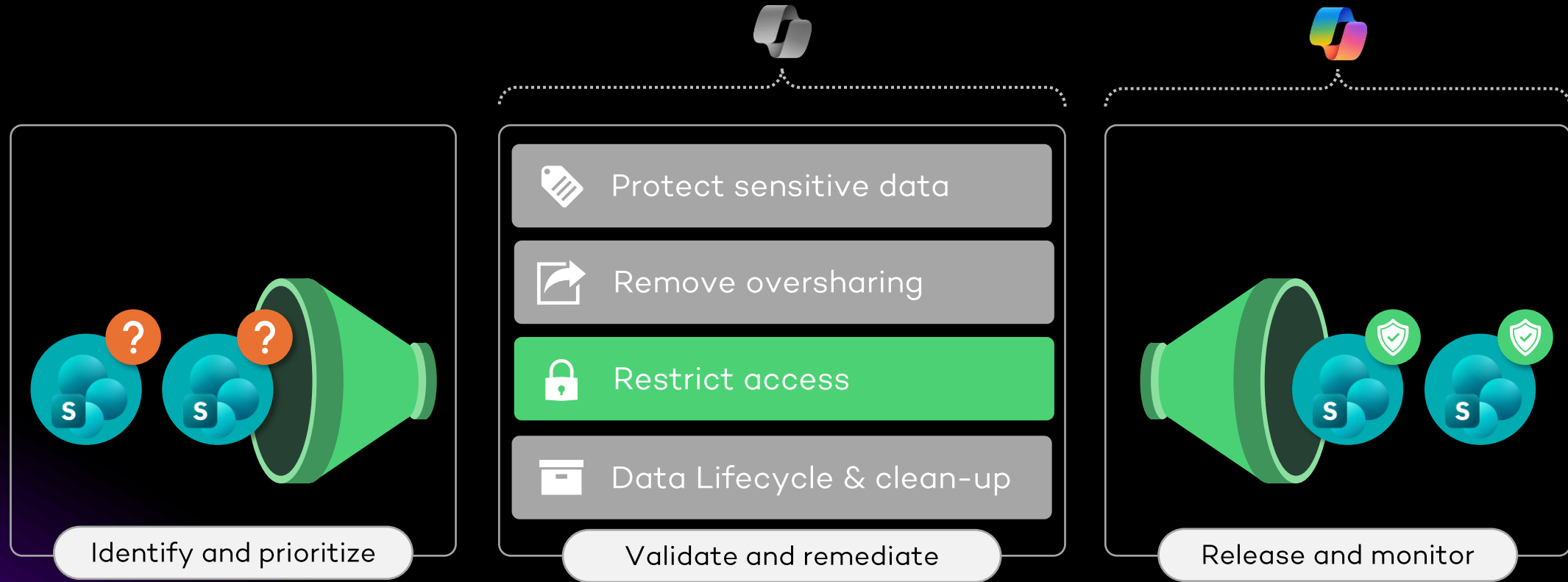
- Insights on risk and compliance
- Label in bulk & reduce oversharing
- Notification to owners.

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Should you label everything?

- Probably not...
- It depends...
- What do you think?

Restrict access



Restrict access for highly sensitive sites

Restricted site access

Use this setting to allow only users in specific groups to access this SharePoint site. You can add up to 10 security groups or Microsoft 365 groups. Users not in these groups will lose access to this SharePoint site.

[Learn more about Restricted Access Control for SharePoint sites](#)

☒ Restrict SharePoint site access to only users in specified groups

Add group

Name (1) ↑



OE - R&D
Department-RD@contoso.onmicrosoft.com

Default group



Wrapping up...

- Work data-driven. Plenty of tools out there
- Information Architecture is key
- Focus on priorities first to reduce highest risk
- Purview DLM can be complex to implement
- Use standards and blueprints
- Evolve over time.



THANK YOU!

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